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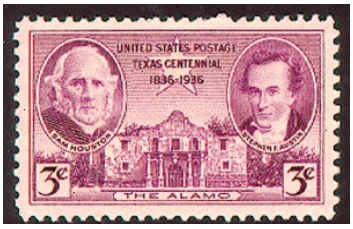
http://www.virtualstampclub.com/apstexas.html

The PHILATEX

A.P.S. Ch. # 53-0388

T.P.A. Life Ch. # 3



MEETING CALENDAR

MARCH			APRIL		
5	Juniors Board of Governors meeting General Meeting Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:00 pm 7:30 pm 7:30 pm	2	NO MEETING - GOOD FRIDAY HAPPY EASTER	
6	Saturday Boursette – buy, sell, trade	9:00 am	9	Juniors Board of Governors meeting General Meeting Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:00 pm 7:30 pm 7:30 pm
12	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:30 pm	10	Saturday Boursette – buy, sell, trade	9:00 am
19	Juniors Program: "Look What Dan Zehr Found" by Jack Virta	6:15 pm 7:30 pm	16	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:30 pm
26	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:00 pm	23	Juniors Program: "Countries That Don't Exist" by Jack Virta	6:15 pm 7:30 pm
	Daylight Savings Time Starts March 14 Turn clock forward 1 hour!		30	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:00 pm

05/07-Jrs, BOG&G, Show&Tell 05/08-Sat.Boursette 05/14-Auction 05/21-Jrs, Program 05/28-Bourse

St Patrick's Day - Mar 17

Editor's Corner

Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts

Arbor Day - Apr 30

As many of you know, Pat Ryan, a long-time SAPA member, has been in the VA hospital for a while undergoing physical therapy. He would enjoy receiving cards (send them to Pat Ryan, PO Box 2757, Universal City, TX 78148) and phone calls. His bedside phone # is 949-3516.

You will notice that there are eight pages in this issue of the Philatex. This is because I needed an extra page for the financial statement for 2009 (p. 8). There was no reason not to fill the remaining blank side, but I was unsure what to use. Jane Fohn kindly came to the rescue. She pointed out that the Chapter Activities Committee of the American Philatelic Society had a number of articles which were available for reprint in member club's newsletters. The article on Balloons (p. 4) is the result. I did, however, add in three illustrations of the stamps which were mentioned in the article. Thanks, Jane, and thank you also to the CAC, and to *The Mayflower, journal of the American Stamp Club of Great Britain,* where the article was originally printed. I hope everyone enjoys it!

Lea

PHILATEX: Editors Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts
Labels Fred Groth
Mailing Jack Virta

The PHILATEX is published every two months and the cut off date is the 2nd Friday of the month prior to publication.

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Write to S.A.P.A. at:
San Antonio Philatelic Association
MacArthur Park Lutheran Church
2903 Nacogdoches Rd.
San Antonio, TX 78217

S.A.P.A. meets at the church every Friday night at 7:30 P.M. in building 1.

ELECTED OFFICERS:

President:	John Clay
Vice President:	Nelda Greer
Secretary:	Pat Richmond
Treasurer:	Fred Groth
Membership Chairman:	Dora Roberts
Communications Chairman:	Judy Grant
Historian:	Fred Groth
Auctioneer:	Jack Virta
Assistant Auctioneer:	John Clay
Librarian:	Richard Rose

BOARD OF GOVERNORS:

Board President:	John Clay
All Elected Officers:	(see above)
Past President:	Jane K Fohn
One year term:	Skip Swinney
Two year term:	Charles Shelby
Parliamentarian:	Bob Joyce
Honorary Board Member	Richard Spies

APPOINTED:

Auditing Committee:	Tony Bir (Chairman)

LIAISON CONTACT PERSONS:

American Philatelic Society:	Fred Groth
Austin-Texas Stamp Club:	Lyle Boardman
Eire Philatelic Association:	Patrick J. Ryan
Texas Philatelic Association:	Robert J. Joyce
U.S. Postal Service:	Steve E. Canedo
APS Circuit Books	John Clay

WE WELCOME VISITORS

SAPA is always happy to welcome visitors. We hope you will enjoy our activities, and wish to join us as members.

All visitors are welcome to purchase stamps at our auctions, bourse, and bag nights. Anyone wishing to sell or trade at our meetings must be a member.

AUCTION ETIQUETTE:

Be sure to get your Bidder's number card before the auction starts. Come early and look over the lots for sale before the auction. During the auction, lots will be identified by their lot number and a brief description of the lot.

When bidding for a lot, please raise your Bidder's Number card and keep it up until you no longer wish to bid. Flipping the card up and down is confusing for the auctioneers.

Please keep extraneous conversation to a minimum. This makes it easier for everyone to hear what the auctioneer is selling, and allows the auctioneer to more easily keep track of the bidding.

Please wait until the end of the auction to pay for your purchases. Your name will be called as the tallys are completed. Those who are only buying will be called first. Buyers who are also sellers will be called next. Checks are acceptable, made out to S.A.P.A.

Sellers with unsold lots should be sure to pick up their lots before leaving.

Please be sure to return the Bidder's Number cards so that we can use them again in the following auctions.

We look forward to meeting you.

President's Message

Happy February to you all. The groundhog did his job and winter is on its way out.

We had to discontinue the Oklahoma circuit books. We were unable to bend Anybody's arm enough to have them take over handling them. Also, people weren't purchasing many stamps from them.

I am still handling the American Philatelic circuit. I should be receiving new additions during the last week of each month. I am also trying to increase the number of books that we will have available due to the problem with having no Oklahoma circuit.

Thanks to you,

John Clay

Nelda's Nook

Thought you might like to check out this site that is mentioned in the Feb APS newsletter website of the month.

AskPhil—a non-commercial, all-reference site sponsored by the Collectors Club of Chicago—offers general answers to questions about stamp collecting. They also provide a reference library, auction information, special features and much more.

* * *

Have you heard about the Virtual Stamp Club? <http://www.virtualstampclub.com> Here is info from their site:

The Virtual Stamp Club was chartered in 1995 as the first electronic chapter of the American Philatelic Society. It is now also a chapter of the American First Day Cover Society. It's a stamp club for those of us online.

Membership requirements are simple: Show up!

It's FREE!

Enter our Message Board: <http://forums.delphiforums.com/stamps/start> and you can count yourself a member of the VSC, APS Chapter #1461, AFDCS Chapter #84. That's all there is to it: No dues, no applications, no oaths, no secret handshakes.

The best philatelic news, information and discussion is here in the Virtual Stamp Club!

Nelda Greer

WELCOME WAGON

We are pleased to announce that we have two new members. We extend to them a welcoming hand, and wish them many years of happy collecting.

Reiko Clay #2806 - collects Japan
Eric Shepherd #2807 - collects France & US

Program Notes

March 19, 2010 "Look What Dan Zehr Found" by Jack Virta

Dan Zehr was president of SAPA in the 60s. These items that Jack is going to show were found by Dan Zehr under a warehouse being torn down. The warehouse dated back to 1880s. Everyone attending will receive an authentic item from the find. Wow, what a bunch of treasures!

April 23, 2010 "Countries That Don't Exist" by Jack Virta

Jack will show you stamps that were issued by countries that really don't exist. Are they stamps or labels??? He will include ideas and examples. The U.P.U. and Scott Publishing Company don't always agree. Examples will be included. Some prizes will be awarded. This sounds very interesting.

Yours in philately, Pat Richmond

UPCOMING SHOWS & BOURSES

MAR 5-6 TEXAS PRECANCEL CLUB SPRING ROUNDUP Spring auction & bourse of the Texas Precancel Club at the College Station Conference Center, 1300 George Bush Dr, College Station, Texas. Hours:Friday 9am-10pm, Saturday 8am-5pm. Auction on Saturday at 2pm. Lunch provided to those who sign up before 10am each day. Contact: Katherine Foster, khfoster@tex.net

APR 16-18 TEXPEX 2010 The 114th annual exhibition & convention of the Texas Philatelic Association at the Doubletree Hotel Dallas near the Galleria, 4099 Valley View Ln (I-635 at Midway exit), Dallas, Texas. Show features World Series of Philately exhibits, bourse, youth booth, USPS substation, cacheted cover & show cancellation. TPA meetings scheduled on Saturday as follows: Foundation Trustees at 8am; Annual Meeting at 9:30am; Board of Directors at 10am. Hours: Friday 11am-6pm, Saturday 10am-6pm. Sunday 10am-4pm. Contact: Tom Koch tkoch@utdallas.edu; (972)883-4951; (972)883-2473.

APR 24-25 TSDA HOUSTON STAMP FAIR Bourse at the TraveLodge, 7611 Katy Frwy., Houston, Texas. Hours: Saturday 10am to 5pm, Sunday 10am to 4pm.

LONE STAR CHAPTER of the Èire Philatelic Association International meets 2nd Saturday between 2:00pm and 4pm every month in member's homes. Various aspects of Irish philately, and philately in general are discussed. All are welcome. For information call (210)658-9235.

Balloon Mania *by Eric Dowell*

The date was 21 November 1783. The location was Paris. Two Frenchmen, standing in a basket which was in turn attached to an untethered hot air balloon, fulfilled a dream of many by becoming the first to succeed in human flight.

The dawn of aviation had arrived when Joseph and Etienne Montgolfier launched an unmanned balloon on 5 June 1783. But the first manned flight was by Jean-Francois Pilatre de Rozier and Francois Laurtent, Marquis d'Arlandes when on 21 November the same year they sailed over Paris in a Montgolfier balloon.

Scott #CL1

In Europe this sparked a great balloon mania. A balloon motif soon became evident on copper engravings, dishes, sculptures, pictures and other items. Chandeliers and baskets were made resembling balloons, while other items were engraved or decorated with balloon motifs. Poets and satirists incorporated ballooning in their works.

Steering a balloon was a difficult business and Jean Pierre Blanchard soon found this out while pioneering his ballooning expertise. In London a cartoonist depicted him in the shape of a giant balloon wearing a dunce's cap.

Edgar Allan Poe asked: "The great problem is accomplished … Who shall say that anything is impossible hereafter?" He was describing an Atlantic crossing of some three days from England to South Carolina made by balloonists who had set out for France and got blown off course. He finally confessed that the event never took place but was a figment of his imagination.

Scott #C54

Jules Verne was the most distinguished writer about ballooning and began his career with a story about a fictional balloon. He wrote about exploring Africa in a balloon - this story being semi-factual. Unfortunately no publisher was interested so Verne threw the work into the fire. His wife rescued it and urged him to try just one more publisher, Jules Hetzel. After re-writing the work to a fictional one, it was eventually published in 1863 and was a great success. The most famous novel of Jules Verne was 'Around the World in Eighty Days', which starred Mike Todd in the 20th century film version. Military uses for balloons were soon developed. Anchored observation balloons were used by Napoleon in some of his battles and by both sides in the American Civil War, and World War I. Anchored balloons were also used as an anti-aircraft device over cities in World War II - the so called Barrage Balloons.

The powered airship was developed from the balloon, but while the airship was soon replaced by the aeroplane, balloons have continued to fulfil a variety of uses. They are still used to aid weather forecasting and the scientific study of the upper atmosphere.

Scott #2530

Today in the age of space exploration, ballooning continues to occupy the minds of aeronauts who try to emulate the pioneers by breaking unheard of records - around the world flights, Arctic and Antarctic flights and flights high into the stratosphere.

The United States has issued several stamps depicting ballooning, such as the Jupiter balloon issue of 1958 (Scott C54), the 1983 balloon issue (Scott 2032 to 2035) and the booklet issue of 1991 (Scott 2530).

Scott #2032-2035

Scott also lists the semi-official Buffalo Balloon post stamp of 1877 (Scott CL1). This was a private issue used on mail carried on a balloon ascent on 18 June 1877 which began at Nashville and landed at Gallatin. It is recorded that 300 copies of the stamp were printed and 23 used on mail.

Reprinted with permission from The Mayflower, journal of the American Stamp Club of Great Britain

http://www.stamp2.com/articles/ascgb/article11.asp

Program Notes January 22, 2010
"First Day Ceremonies" by Nelda Greer

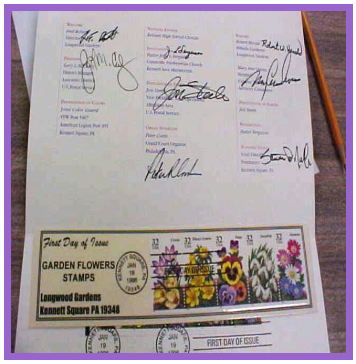
Nelda came in to the club meeting like a queen bee with her "minions" (her husband and son) carrying a laundry basket full of very interesting notebooks filled with her collection of First Day Ceremony Programs and many, many door prizes for our enjoyment.

In the picture at right, you can see Nelda holding one of her favorite programs, because she said she "loves tassles." You can let your imagination go from there. It was a pretty program.

The American Ceremony Program Society organizes programs into eleven categories: 1) Invitations, 2) First Day Ceremony Programs, 3) Supplemental Ceremony Programs, 4) Event Programs, 5) Official Souvenirs, 6) Presentation Albums, 7) Unveiling Programs, 8) Unveiling Souvenirs, 9) Unveiling Presentation Albums, 10) Press Kits, and 11) Other collectibles associated with ceremonies.

The earliest reported first day ceremony program was the 1940 Mark Twain Famous American Issue. The USPOD (USPS after July, 1971) did not regularly organize ceremonies for the general public to attend until a few years later. These public ceremonies became a regular event after the 1950s.

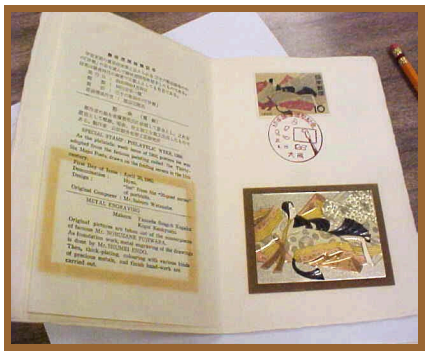
The ceremony is an opportunity for the attendees to learn about the stamp's background and why its topic was chosen from the more than 50,000 suggestions that the USPS receives every year.

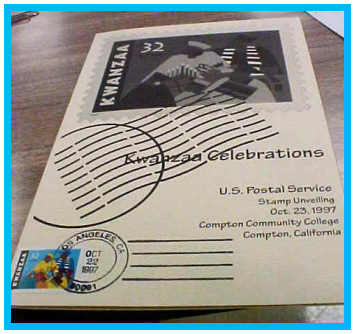


The program usually contains the first day cancelled stamp , but it must always have a list of speakers and their duties. Of course the program itself is more valuable to the collector if it is autographed by the participants in [➜] the program. One of my favorites was this program that is not only signed by most of the participants, but also has a first day of issue cancelled bookmark of the garden flower stamp.

[⬆] Sometimes the attendees get press kits loaded with goodies. Nelda showed us one that not only had the program and a First Day Cover, but many other philatelic wonders. You can see how delighted she is with this press kit.

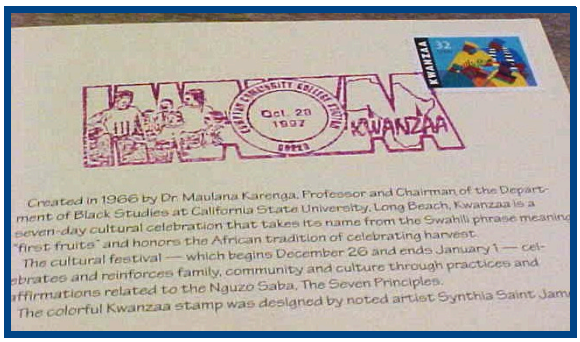
[⬇] The range of extravagance expended on these programs varies from a simple page that is printed up with the various information to those like the one at left that had a beautiful metal engraving in it.





Not only can a collector concentrate on these beautiful programs and memorabilia from first day ceremonies, but one might use them as "cross-overs" into other subjects. An excellent example is the program for [➜] the Kwanzaa stamp. As you can see it could be included in Holidays, Black History, Kwanzaa as well as pictorial cancels. [⬇]

These are affordable collectables. You can find these programs from all the regular sources. If you attend a meeting of the FDCPS, you may receive gifts from generous members. Programs may also be purchased using <u>Mellone's Specialized Catalogue of First Day Ceremony Programs and Events.</u>



Nelda's program was very interesting and informative. She had many doorprizes available for those who attended. If you missed this interesting program, you truly missed a charming presentation. Thank you Nelda, we really enjoyed it.

Yours in philately, Pat Richmond

"Ph"eatured "Ph"ilatelist
Frank Boehm

Frank Boehm was born on July 14, 1936 in the Durand Hospital in Durand, Wisconsin. He lived in Durand until he graduated from Durand High School in 1954.

After graduating from high school, he wanted to go into the military, but his parents insisted he go to school. So, he went to St. Thomas University in St. Paul, Minnesota to major in history—however, as we all know Frank, he pretty much did what he wanted to do! He actually majored in "Beer, Girls and Shooting Pool" (He didn't tell us who "Pool" was!) He continued in that vein (vain???) until he ran through the 10K that he inherited from his grandfather when he (Frank) became 18 years old.

Then, in 1958, in order to avoid the draft, he enlisted in the Air Force, which is what he wanted to do in the first place!!! After boot camp, he went to Syracuse University in New York for one year to study the Russian Language, under the auspices of the Air Force.

He spent the next 2 years in Germany as a Russian and German linguist. The last year of his enlistment was spent in Crete monitoring International Phone Calls. In 1961 he intercepted a call from Khruschev to his grandchildren. At that time he was on a ship on his way from Leningrad to New York City. That was the time Khruschev went to the UN (Do you remember the "shoe banging" incident? Well, that was the time!) According to procedure, Frank turned the intercepted call over to the NSA.

Frank got out of the Air Force in 1962 and went back to the University of Wisconsin where he graduated with a Bachelor's degree in Russian History. He then went into officer's training school. Beginning in 1963, he spent 6 years as an aircraft maintenance officer. During 1967-68 in the Philippines, Chuck Yeager was his wing commander.

In 1969, he was in the Intelligence department at Kelly analyzing SR71 flights over North Vietnam and China.

In 1970-71 he got a M.A. in European History at St. Mary's University in San Antonio, Texas. Then from 1972-75, he was an instructor at the Officers' Training School at Lackland Air Force Base in San Antonio, Texas.

In 1975-78, Frank went to Hahn Air Base, Germany as a maintenance officer of 3 squadrons of F-4's. He returned to San Antonio from 1978-81 and was in charge of the Academic Division at OTS at Lackland.

He retired in 1981. From 1981-83 he went to UTSA. In 1983 he got a BA in German Language.

Then, from 1983 to 2007, he was a substitute teacher at Clark High School. He taught English, Geography, German, Russian and History. (Can you imagine what his classes were like??? I suspect he was fun, but took no prisoners—after all, he had probably done or watched everything they were going to try or even think of in the next 4 years!!!)

In 1963, he married Judith Rippley in Durand, Wisconsin. He said he had known her since they started school, but he didn't really "notice" her until 1961 when she was grown up. (I suspect it was really when Frank "grew up" if he ever has!) They have three children: Gerald, 45, Paulette 43, and Fritz 40. There are 6 grandchildren.

Frank started collecting stamps in 1947 when his dad got some "unsolicited" approvals in the mail (we all know about those, don't we?!) From there he went to an album and has continued to this day. He has collected worldwide, Austria, Germany and Swiss. He has pretty much given up all except Swiss. He began to view his stamps from a "topical" standpoint when he began to make topical packets for Kurt Harding. He did that for 15 years. Incidentally, he has been extremely generous with the Juniors and their topical collections. In fact, he and Jack Virta were mainly responsible for the topical stamp prizes that the Juniors have gotten over the years. Thanks, Guys!!!

Frank joined SAPA in approximately 1980 and has been an active member since then. We all enjoy Frank at the meetings. He has a great sense of humor—some jokes are funny, and others—well, you know Frank. Anyway, Frank you're a lot of fun and an asset to the stamp club. Thanks for being a part of our group.

Yours in philately, Pat Richmond

Editor's Album by John L. Leszak

Round the Clock Philatelic Enthusiasts (part 3)

(This is the last part of an editoral taken from ***Mekeel's and Stamps Magazine, Feb. 13,* 2009.** Thanks, ***Stamp News,*** for your kind permission. What a great magazine! ***Stamp News*** can be contacted at: <http://www.stampnewsnow.com>, phone **800-635-3351**, or mail to **Stamp News, 42 Sentry Way, Merrimack, NH, 03054**.)

Some philatelists take out their stamp collections once a year to insert new supplements into their albums. Others dabble with their stamps and covers for a half hour before dinner or before bedtime. Many will occasionally carve out a weekend to devote entirely to their philatelic endeavors.

However, there's also that rare and dynamic breed of philatelists. They're the folks who have incorporated philately into their daily living routine. They practice their philately with a 24/7 level of enthusiasm and their very lives are interwoven within a philatelic infrastructure. Some people are on the brink of becoming Round the Clock Philatelic Enthusiasts and don't even realize it. Others are so immersed in their 24/7 philatelic endeavors that the rest of the world is simply background noise.

Those who embrace philately on a 24/7 basis truly reap the joy that's derived from philatelic inthusiasm. Non-philatelists might deem such enthusiasm to be eccentric, but in reality, they simply do not realize how much fun philatelists are having.

In order to properly diagnose if you're a Round the Clock Phila-telic Enthusiast, the following list of signs and symptoms has been assembled.

★You set up several small tables for stamp or cover sorting projects.

★You have a necktie with a stamp motif.

★You receive gift certificates to your favorite stamp dealer as Christmas or birthday presents.

★You've made a vest out of material that has a philatelic pattern.

★You remove your socks and find a stamp stuck to the heel of the left sock.

★While your neighbors clamor with snowblowers during a blizzard, you work on sorting covers.

★You set up a table in front of a large window because the lighting is ideal for working with stamps.

★You keep a small table that's cluttered with stamps next to your easy chair.

★You go out camping, and bring a philatelic project along.

★Your spouse knows that you've spent an obscene amount of money on stamps because you suddenly buy him/her an expensive gift for no apparent reason.

★You frequently ask the question, "Where are my stamp tongs?"

★You wear a round button on ypur lapel or purse that says "Kiss Me, I'm a Philatelist."

★You poke through dumpsters in search of used stamps.

★You send out more than three emails per day that relate to stamps or covers.

★You use duct tape to mend a stamp album because the money you save from not buying a new album can be used to buy more stamps.

★You recycle old glassine envelopes.

★You purchase Philatelic gifts for Grandchildren, nieces and nephews.

★You save all of your incoming mail for its postal history potential.

★You take this editorial to your stamp club and read it out loud to your fellow club members. (And everyone nods and laughs! - Lea)

★ ★

If ten or more of the above scenarios relate to you, you are definitely a Round the Clock Enthusiast. If five to nine of the scenarios pertain to your philatelic endeavors, then you are on your way to becoming a Round the Clock Enthusiast. If one to four scenarios pertain to your present philatelic condition, you're working too hard; take a weekend off and play with your stamps. If none of these scenarios pertain to you, then you're in the wrong hobby, and you should take up face painting, darts or making snowmen.

As always, your comments and observations are invited!

(Thanks, John, for the use of your delightful column! We have all enjoyed it!- Lea)

John Clay and Jane Fohn
January 22, 2010

On January 22, 2010, John Clay, our president for 2010 presented Jane Fohn with a plaque of appreciation for her excellent service as president of the San Antonio Philatelic Association during the years 2008 and 2009.

Thanks, Jane for a job well done.